



Google Ads Playbook 2026

Benchmarks | Diagnosis | Optimisation

Stop guessing. Find the leak,
fix it in the right order, then scale.

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How this playbook works

Three parts. One loop. Use it every week on every account.

Most Google Ads advice tells you *what* to change. This playbook tells you **in what order**. Most wasted budget comes from tweaking bids when the conversion tracking is wrong, or adding keywords when the search terms are already leaking money.

Part	Question it answers	You will get
1. Benchmarks	Is my number normal, and is it profitable?	Global and India ranges, industry CPC, break-even math (max CPC and required CVR)
2. Diagnosis	What exactly is broken?	A 7-layer diagnosis order, impression share and Quality Score reading, search-term audit, PMax and Shopping checks
3. Optimisation	What do I change, and when do I scale?	Structure, keywords, RSA copy, bidding ladder, scale/hold/fix/kill rules, weekly routine, 30-day plan

The loop

Benchmark (where am I?) → **Diagnose** (what is leaking?) → **Optimise** (change one thing) → **Measure** (wait for data) → repeat.

Four rules used throughout

- **Fix in order.** Conversion tracking → settings → search terms and keywords → ads → landing page → bidding → budget.
- **Judge Search by CVR and CPA, not CTR alone.** A great CTR with poor conversions still loses money.
- **Change one variable at a time,** and give Smart Bidding time (often 1-2 weeks) before judging.
- **Log everything.** A change you did not write down is a change you cannot learn from.

About the numbers

Google Search reference ranges are synthesized from 2026 benchmark reports (WordStream/LocaliQ analysis of 13,474 US search campaigns, Apr 2025 – Mar 2026). Figures outside Search are directional, not official Google averages. Every threshold in this book (like “30 conversions in 30 days for Target CPA”) is a **rule of thumb**, not an official Google requirement.

PART

1

Benchmarks

Know what normal looks like, then know what profitable looks like.

1.1 Read benchmarks by campaign type and intent

Campaign type	Role	Captures or creates demand?	Judge mainly by
Search	Reaches people already looking	Captures demand	CVR, CPA, impression share
Performance Max	AI-run across all Google inventory	Mostly captures, some creation	Conversion value, ROAS, CPA, incrementality
Shopping	Product listings for buyers	Captures demand	ROAS, CPA, purchase rate, feed quality
Display	Banners across the web	Creates demand, remarketing	Reach, assisted conversions, CPM
YouTube	Video across YouTube	Creates demand	View rate, CPV, assisted conversions

1.2 Google Ads benchmarks: Global (\$)

Metric	2026 Benchmark (Global)	Meaning / Notes
Search CTR	4% – 8%	% of search impressions clicked
Search CPC	\$1.00 – \$6.00	Avg. cost per search click
Search Conversion Rate	3% – 8%	% of clicks that converted
Search CPL / CPA	\$30 – \$100	Cost per lead / conversion
Search Impression Share	40% – 70%	% of eligible search impressions won
Brand Search CTR	10% – 30%	CTR for branded queries
Brand Search CPC	\$0.15 – \$1.00	Avg. cost per branded click
Quality Score	5 – 7 / 10	Diagnostic for keyword, ad and landing-page relevance
Display CTR	0.3% – 0.8%	% of display impressions clicked
Display CPC	\$0.20 – \$1.00	Avg. cost per display click
Display Conversion Rate	0.5% – 1.5%	% of display clicks that converted
Display CPA	\$30 – \$100	Cost per conversion
Shopping CTR	0.8% – 1.8%	% of Shopping impressions clicked
Shopping CPC	\$0.30 – \$0.90	Avg. Shopping click cost
Shopping Conversion Rate	1.5% – 3.5%	% of Shopping clicks that converted
Shopping CPA	\$15 – \$50	Cost per purchase / conversion
Shopping ROAS	3.0x – 6.0x	Revenue divided by ad spend
Performance Max CTR	1.2% – 2.6%	Click rate across PMax inventory
Performance Max CPC	\$0.45 – \$1.20	Avg. PMax click cost
Performance Max Conv. Rate	1.8% – 3.0%	% of PMax clicks that converted

Metric	2026 Benchmark (Global)	Meaning / Notes
Performance Max CPA	\$20 – \$60	Cost per conversion
Performance Max ROAS	3.0x – 5.0x	Revenue divided by ad spend
YouTube View Rate	15% – 35%	% of impressions counted as views
YouTube CTR	0.5% – 1.5%	% of video ad impressions clicked
YouTube CPV	\$0.01 – \$0.05	Cost per counted video view
YouTube Conversion Rate	1.5% – 3.0%	% of clicks that converted

Ranges are synthesized from 2026 benchmark reports. Figures outside Search are directional, not official Google global averages.

1.3 Google Ads benchmarks: India (₹)

Metric	Ideal Benchmark (India)	Meaning / Notes
CTR (Search)	3% – 7%	% of people who click your ad
CTR (Display)	0.5% – 2%	% of people who click your ad
CPC (Search)	₹15 – ₹90	Avg. cost per click (higher in competitive niches)
CPC (Display)	₹10 – ₹50	Avg. cost per click
CPM (Search)	₹100 – ₹300	Cost per 1,000 impressions
CPM (Display)	₹50 – ₹200	Cost per 1,000 impressions
Conversion Rate (Search)	2% – 7%	% of visitors who take action
Conversion Rate (Display)	0.5% – 2%	% of visitors who take action
Cost Per Acquisition (CPA)	₹500 – ₹5,000	Cost to get one customer / lead
Cost Per Lead (CPL)	₹300 – ₹2,000	Cost to get one lead
Landing Page CVR	2% – 6%	% of clicks that become leads / sales
ROAS (Search)	3x – 5x	Return on ad spend
ROAS (Display)	2x – 4x	Return on ad spend
Impression Share	30% – 70%	% of total available impressions
Quality Score	7/10+	Ad relevance, landing page, CTR
Avg. Position	1.5 – 3.5	Lower is better (top of page)
Search Lost IS (Rank)	10% – 30%	Share lost due to lower ad rank

Industry-wise Search CPC (India)

Industry	CPC range	Industry	CPC range
E-commerce	₹5 – ₹100	B2B Services	₹30 – ₹300
Education	₹20 – ₹150	SaaS / Technology	₹40 – ₹350
Healthcare	₹20 – ₹150	Finance / Insurance	₹50 – ₹500+
Real Estate	₹30 – ₹250	Legal Services	₹50 – ₹500+

Directional ranges. Local, high-value niches (legal, finance, real estate) can run well above these in metro cities.

1.4 What to monitor for each campaign type

Campaign type	Watch these metrics	Best for
Search	CTR, Conversion Rate (CVR), CPA, Impression Share, Keyword relevance, Search term quality	High-intent traffic and measurable conversions
Display	Reach, CTR, Viewability, Conversions (assisted), CPM, Audience quality	Brand awareness and remarketing
Shopping	CTR, Add to Cart rate, Purchase rate, CPA, ROAS, Product feed quality	E-commerce and product-driven brands
Performance Max	Conversion value, ROAS, CPA, Asset performance, Audience signals, Incrementality	Combines all Google inventory with AI optimization
YouTube	Reach, View rate, CPV, Video conversion rate, Brand lift, Assisted conversions	Awareness, consideration and remarketing

1.5 Break-even math: the benchmark that decides profit

A benchmark tells you what is **normal**. Break-even tells you what is **profitable**. On Google Search the key link is between CPC, CVR and CPA.

Question	Formula	Example
What CPC can I afford?	$\text{Max CPC} = \text{CVR} \times \text{target CPA}$	$4\% \times ₹1,000 = \text{₹40}$
What CVR do I need?	$\text{Required CVR} = \text{CPC} \div \text{target CPA}$	$₹90 \div ₹1,000 = 9\%$
Break-even CPA (e-commerce)	$\text{AOV} \times \text{gross margin}$	$₹1,500 \times 40\% = \text{₹600}$
Break-even ROAS	$1 \div \text{gross margin}$	$1 \div 0.40 = 2.5x$
Max CPL (lead gen)	$\text{Lead} \rightarrow \text{customer rate} \times (\text{customer value} \times \text{margin})$	$5\% \times (₹20,000 \times 60\%) = \text{₹600}$

The uncomfortable truth about expensive keywords

If your niche CPC is ₹90 and your target CPA is ₹1,000, you need a **9% conversion rate** just to break even on that keyword. If your page converts at 3%, that keyword will lose money no matter how well you “optimise” bids. Either lift CVR, raise the value per customer, or bid on cheaper, more specific terms.

1.6 Your baseline sheet

Fill this from your last 30 days before you change anything.

Metric	My last 30 days	Benchmark range	My target	Status
Spend				
CTR				
CPC				
CVR				
CPL / CPA				
ROAS				
Impression share				
Lost IS (budget) / (rank)				
Quality Score (avg. of top keywords)				
Break-even CPA / max CPC				

PART
2

Diagnosis

Find the real problem before you touch a single bid.

2.1 The 7-layer diagnosis order

Always start at layer 1. If a layer is broken, every layer below it gives you misleading data.

#	Layer	Ask	Broken looks like
1	Conversion tracking	Does Google count the conversions that really matter?	Conversions include junk, duplicates or nothing at all
2	Campaign settings	Is the traffic coming from the right places and devices?	Clicks from wrong locations, Search partners or Display expansion
3	Search terms and keywords	Are the right searches triggering the ads?	Irrelevant search terms eating budget
4	Ads and assets	Do ads earn the click for the right reason?	Low CTR, weak Quality Score, generic copy
5	Landing page and offer	Does the page match the search intent?	Good CTR but low CVR
6	Bidding	Is the strategy suited to your data volume?	Volatile CPA, underspend, Smart Bidding stuck
7	Budget and impression share	Are you missing profitable demand?	Lost IS (budget) high on profitable campaigns

2.2 Layer 1: conversion tracking audit

- ☐ Only **real business goals** (purchase, qualified lead, booked call) are set as **primary** conversions. Page views and button clicks are secondary or removed.
- ☐ No **duplicate counting**: the same action is not counted by both a GA4 import and a Google Ads tag.
- ☐ **Enhanced conversions** are turned on (and checked in Diagnostics).
- ☐ Auto-tagging is on; GA4 is linked; the Google tag fires correctly (test with Tag Assistant).
- ☐ Conversion **value** is passed for sales (and a value assigned to lead stages if you can).
- ☐ For lead gen, the GCLID is captured in your form and CRM so **offline conversions** can be imported.
- ☐ Consent Mode is set up where required (for example EEA traffic).
- ☐ Conversion window and counting method (one vs every) match the business.

If Google shows 50 leads and your CRM shows 12 real ones, your bidding is optimising for the wrong thing. Fix this before anything else.

2.3 Layer 2: campaign settings check

Setting	Check	Why it matters
Locations	Use Presence (people in your location), not “Presence or interest”, unless you serve travellers	Prevents clicks from people who only search about a place
Networks (Search)	Turn off Display expansion; test Search partners separately	Search partners and Display can dilute quality
Devices	Compare CVR and CPA by device	A page that converts on desktop but not mobile hides waste
Ad schedule	Compare conversions by day and hour	Some businesses only convert during call-answering hours
Languages	Match the language of your ads and page	Mismatch tanks CTR and CVR
Status labels	Check for “Limited by budget”, “Learning”, “Limited” bid strategy	Tells you if the problem is budget or bidding

2.4 Impression share diagnosis

Impression share (IS) tells you how much eligible demand you are winning and why you lose the rest.

Signal	What it means	Fix
Lost IS (budget) high	You are profitable but run out of daily budget.	Raise budget on profitable campaigns; tighten targeting; lower CPA target only if volume allows.
Lost IS (rank) high	Ad Rank is too low: bid, Quality Score or expected impact.	Improve Quality Score (2.5), raise bids or targets gradually, improve ad relevance.
Top / absolute top IS low	You are showing lower on the page.	Raise targets or improve ad quality if top positions convert well.
IS high, CVR low	You win auctions but the traffic is not converting.	This is a landing page or keyword-intent problem, not a bidding problem.
IS low on brand terms	Competitors bid on your name.	Run a brand campaign, watch competitor ads, strengthen brand ad copy.

Do not chase 100% impression share. Aim for high share on profitable terms and accept low share where CPA is above break-even.

2.5 Quality Score: three parts, three fixes

Quality Score (1-10) is a diagnostic, not a goal. Look at each component at keyword level and fix the one marked “below average”.

Component	Below average means	How to fix
Expected CTR	Your ad is less likely to be clicked than competitors' for this keyword.	Rewrite headlines around the search term, add clear benefit and CTA, use assets (sitelinks, callouts), tighten keyword-to-ad match.
Ad relevance	Ad does not match what the keyword promises.	Split the ad group into tighter themes; put the keyword theme in headlines.
Landing page experience	Page is slow, irrelevant, or hard to use.	Match the headline to the search, improve speed and mobile layout, make the next step obvious.

2.6 Search terms report audit

The search terms report is the most valuable diagnosis screen in Google Ads. Review it weekly.

Type of term	What to do
Relevant and converting	Add as exact or phrase keyword; write ad copy for it; consider its own ad group if volume is high.
Relevant, not converting yet	Watch. If spend exceeds ~2-3× target CPA with zero conversions, check the landing page before blaming the keyword.
Irrelevant	Add as a negative keyword at the right level (ad group, campaign, or account list).
Right topic, wrong intent	Negative in phrase or exact form (for example jobs, free, DIY, salary, definition, PDF), adjusted to your business.

Starter negative keyword themes (adapt to your business)

Theme	Examples	Careful when
Job seekers	jobs, careers, salary, hiring, internship	You are actually recruiting
Freebie seekers	free, template, download, pdf, sample	Your offer includes a free trial or free audit
Research / learning	meaning, definition, what is, course, tutorial	You sell courses or content
DIY / wrong product	DIY, how to make, repair kit, used, second hand	You sell repairs or used goods
Competitors / brands	competitor names you cannot serve	You want to bid on competitors on purpose

2.7 Metric-by-metric diagnosis

Symptom	Likely causes	How to confirm	Fix
Low CTR	Ad not matching the query; generic copy; low position; broad-match drift.	Search terms report; CTR by keyword and ad; average position / top IS.	Rewrite RSA around the intent, tighten match types, add assets.
High CPC	Competitive keywords; low Quality Score; broad terms; aggressive targets.	CPC by keyword; Quality Score; auction insights.	Improve QS, move to more specific long-tail keywords, review Smart Bidding targets.
Low CVR	Intent mismatch; weak offer; slow or confusing page; mobile issues.	CVR by device and keyword; page speed; session recordings.	Match page to search intent, shorten the form, add proof and a call or WhatsApp option.
High CPA / CPL	CPC too high, CVR too low, or both; wasted spend on irrelevant terms.	Break $CPA = CPC \div CVR$. See which one moved.	Fix the weaker of CPC or CVR first; add negatives; remove wasteful keywords.
Low ROAS	Low AOV; weak offer; unprofitable products; brand vs non-brand mix.	ROAS by campaign, product and search term.	Separate brand and non-brand; cut dead products; raise AOV; adjust targets.
Low impression share	Budget or rank problem (see 2.4).	Lost IS (budget) vs lost IS (rank).	Fix the dominant cause only.
Underdelivery / low spend	Targets too strict; budgets too low; too narrow targeting; ads disapproved.	Status column; bid strategy status; policy tab.	Relax targets, broaden match or audience, fix disapprovals.
Low lead quality	Broad match drift; junk queries; easy forms; wrong offline signal.	Lead → qualified → sale by keyword; search terms.	Tighten intent, add qualifying form questions, import offline conversions.

2.8 Pattern reading: combinations tell the real story

Pattern	Diagnosis	Action
High CTR + low CVR	Curiosity traffic or intent mismatch (often broad match), or a weak landing page.	Tighten match types and negatives; match the page to the query.
Low CTR + high impression share	You show often but the ad does not earn clicks.	Rewrite ads, test new angles and assets.
Conversions up, revenue flat	Junk leads or micro-conversions counted as primary.	Change primary conversion, import offline sales.
ROAS looks great, growth is flat	Brand campaign or PMax brand traffic inflating results.	Separate brand from non-brand; check PMax search term insights.
CPA swings wildly with Smart Bidding	Too few conversions, or a target that is too tight.	Consolidate campaigns, loosen targets by 10–15%, wait out learning.
Mobile CPA » desktop CPA	Mobile page or form is poor.	Fix mobile UX or adjust device bids.
Good CPL, poor sales	Lead quality issue.	Optimise for qualified leads; import offline conversions.
Spend concentrated on few keywords	Normal: budget flows to proven terms.	Add new themes rather than forcing spend.

2.9 Bidding diagnosis

- **Data volume rule of thumb:** Target CPA works best with roughly 30+ conversions in 30 days per campaign; Target ROAS with roughly 50+. With less, use Maximize Conversions or consolidate campaigns.
- **Target too aggressive?** Spend drops and impression share collapses. Loosen by 10–15% at a time.
- **Learning period:** after a major change, give it 1–2 weeks. Constant edits keep the system in learning forever.
- **Conversion delay:** if leads convert to sales in weeks, do not judge last week's CPA on last week's sales.

2.10 Performance Max diagnosis

Check	What to look at	If it looks bad
Brand cannibalisation	Search term insights and any brand-related reporting	Use brand exclusions and a separate Search brand campaign so PMax does not take credit for brand traffic.
Channel mix	Channel performance report (where available)	Heavy spend on low-quality inventory means weak assets or signals; add stronger video and image assets.
Asset groups	Asset performance ratings and coverage	Replace low-rated assets; make one asset group per product theme or margin band.
Audience signals and search themes	Are they specific to your best customers?	Feed real customer lists and specific themes; treat them as hints, not hard limits.
Incrementality	Would these sales have happened anyway?	Compare with holdouts or geo tests; watch new-customer share where available.
Feed (retail)	Feed quality and product-level results	Fix titles, images, GTINs, pricing; split high-margin and low-margin products.

2.11 Shopping diagnosis

- **Low impressions:** feed disapprovals, weak titles (no keywords), missing GTIN or brand, uncompetitive price.
- **Low CTR:** poor main image, unclear title, price out of range versus competitors.
- **High clicks, no sales:** price, shipping, reviews, or a landing page that does not match the product.
- **Dead products:** products with many clicks and zero sales. Separate or exclude them so budget goes to real sellers.

2.12 Account health check

Score each line: 0 = broken, 1 = partly, 2 = good. Total out of 20.

#	Check	Score (0/1/2)
1	Primary conversions are real business goals; no duplicates	
2	Enhanced conversions and offline import (for leads) are set up	
3	Search terms reviewed weekly; negatives up to date	
4	Brand and non-brand are separated	
5	Ad groups are tightly themed; RSAs have 8+ unique headlines	
6	Landing page matches search intent and is fast on mobile	
7	Break-even CPA / ROAS and max CPC are known	
8	Bid strategy fits conversion volume	
9	Impression share losses are understood (budget vs rank)	
10	A change log exists and is updated	

Reading your score

0-8: fix tracking and basics before optimising. **9-14:** optimise search terms, ads and pages. **15-20:** ready to scale carefully.

PART 3

Optimisation

Change the right thing, in the right order, and scale only what works.

3.1 The optimisation priority order

1. Tracking → 2. Search terms and negatives → 3. Keywords and structure → 4. Ads → 5. Landing page → 6. Bidding → 7. Budget scaling

Golden rule

Do not scale a leaky account. Cut waste first (negatives, dead keywords, weak pages), then scale what converts profitably.

3.2 Account structure: themed and simple

Principle	How to apply
Separate brand and non-brand	Different intent, CVR and CPA. Mixing them hides the truth.
Themed ad groups	Group keywords by one intent. Ideal is about 5-20 keywords per ad group so ads stay relevant.
Fewer, stronger campaigns	Smart Bidding needs data. Consolidate small campaigns with the same goal.
Separate by economics	Split when CPA targets differ (for example high-margin vs low-margin services or products).
One landing page per intent	Send each theme to the page that matches it, not to the homepage.

3.3 Keyword strategy

Match type	Use when	Risk
Exact	Proven, high-intent terms; strict cost control	May limit volume
Phrase	Good balance of control and reach	Can still pick up loose variants
Broad (with Smart Bidding and strong conversion data)	You have volume and good tracking, and want to discover new queries	Needs tight negatives and clean conversions; can drift without them

Intent tiers

Tier	Example words	Expected CVR and CPC
High intent	buy, price, near me, hire, agency, quote, book	Best CVR, highest CPC
Mid intent	best, compare, vs, reviews, top	Medium CVR, medium CPC
Low intent	what is, how to, guide, ideas	Low CVR, low CPC. Better for content or remarketing

- Start with high-intent keywords, then expand through the search terms report.
- Keep account-level negative lists for permanent junk themes.
- Review negatives weekly for the first month, then every 2 weeks.

3.4 Responsive Search Ad (RSA) copy

You can add up to 15 headlines and 4 descriptions per RSA. Use the space with **distinct** messages, not rewordings of one idea.

Headline group	How many	Example (marketing agency)
Keyword match	3-4	"Google Ads Agency in Delhi", "Performance Marketing Services"
Benefit / result	3-4	"Lower Your Cost per Lead", "More Qualified Leads"
Proof	2-3	"CPL ₹150 → ₹100 in 30 Days", "7.5x ROAS Case Study"
Offer / urgency	2	"Free Account Audit", "Book a 15-Min Call"
CTA	2	"Get Your Free Audit", "Talk to an Expert"
Brand	1	"Trendedit Agency"

- Pin only when you must (legal text, brand). Heavy pinning reduces Google's ability to test combinations.
- Read **asset performance labels** and replace low performers every 2-4 weeks.
- Use assets: sitelinks, callouts, structured snippets, call, lead form, image, price where relevant. They raise CTR and Ad Rank.
- Test with **experiments** when you change something big, so you can compare fairly.

3.5 Landing page and offer

☐	The headline repeats the search intent (message match). Searching "Google Ads agency Delhi" should land on a page that says exactly that.
☐	One goal and one clear CTA above the fold; navigation kept minimal.
☐	Loads in under ~3 seconds on mobile; images compressed.
☐	Proof: numbers, logos, testimonials, case studies near the form.
☐	Form asks only what you need (3-5 fields); phone validated.
☐	Call and WhatsApp buttons for India, with call tracking or event tracking so those actions count.
☐	The thank-you page or event fires the conversion and explains the next step.

3.6 The bidding ladder

Stage	Strategy	Move up when
1. New / low data	Maximize Conversions (no target), or manual CPC for a tiny test	You reach roughly 30 conversions in 30 days per campaign
2. Stable data	Target CPA (lead gen) or Maximize Conversion Value (e-commerce)	CPA is stable and you have roughly 50 conversions for ROAS
3. Mature	Target ROAS with realistic targets, segmented by economics	Keep tuning targets in small steps

- Change targets by **10-15%** at a time, then wait 1-2 weeks.
- Feed the algorithm **good signals**: clean conversions, values, offline sales, customer lists.
- Never switch strategy and change ads and change the page in the same week.

3.7 Scale / Hold / Fix / Kill rules

Use your **target CPA** (from section 1.5) as the ruler. Judge over 2-4 weeks or 30+ conversions, not a couple of days.

Decision	When (CPA vs target)	Action
Scale	CPA at or below ~80% of target, and Lost IS (budget) is high	Raise budget about 20% at a time; add new keyword themes; expand to nearby locations.
Hold	CPA about 80-120% of target	Leave it. Test one new ad or page variation.
Fix	CPA about 120-150% of target	Fix the weaker of CPC or CVR: search terms, ads or page first, bidding last.
Kill	CPA above ~150% after spend of 2-3× target CPA and no improvement	Pause the keyword or ad group, log why, move budget to winners.

Ways to scale

- **Budget:** raise on profitable campaigns limited by budget.
- **Coverage:** new keyword themes, new locations, remarketing (RLSA), customer match.
- **Formats:** add Shopping or PMax once feed and tracking are strong; add YouTube and Display for remarketing and demand creation.

3.8 Performance Max and Shopping optimisation

Area	What to do
Feed (retail)	Titles with brand + product type + key attribute; correct GTIN; strong main image; fix disapprovals; competitive pricing.
Asset groups	One per product theme or margin band; add strong images, video and 5+ headlines that differ; replace low-rated assets.
Signals and themes	Use customer lists and specific search themes as hints for your best buyers.
Brand control	Use brand exclusions and a separate brand Search campaign to keep results honest.
Budget	Give PMax enough conversion volume to learn; do not edit targets weekly.
Testing	Test one variable at a time: new asset group, new theme, target change. Log results.

3.9 The weekly and monthly routine

When	Task	Time
Daily	Check spend pacing, disapprovals, sudden CPC or conversion swings. Do not optimise on daily noise.	5 min
Weekly	Search terms report: add negatives and winning keywords. Review ads and assets. Check lost IS. Compare CPA vs target. Update the change log.	45 min
Every 2 weeks	Landing page review, device and hour reports, bid target adjustment (10-15% steps).	1 hour
Monthly	Tracking audit (2.2), structure clean-up, refresh baseline and break-even, plan next tests.	2 hours

3.10 The 30-day optimisation plan

Week	Focus	Deliverables
1	Tracking + baseline	Conversion audit, baseline sheet, break-even CPA and max CPC, health score
2	Cut waste	Search terms audit, negative lists, pause dead keywords, separate brand and non-brand
3	Ads + landing page	New RSAs with distinct angles, assets added, page matched to search intent
4	Scale winners	Budget raised ~20% on profitable campaigns, new keyword themes, next month's test plan

3.11 Worked example (illustrative numbers)

A local service business spends ₹60,000 a month on Search. These are **illustrative** numbers to show how the layers compound. They are not a client result.

Metric	Before	After	What changed
Spend	₹60,000	₹60,000	Same budget
CPC	₹50	₹42	Negatives and tighter match types cut junk clicks
Clicks	1,200	1,428	$₹60,000 \div ₹42$
CVR	4.0%	5.5%	Landing page matched to intent, shorter form, call button
Leads	48	~79	Clicks × CVR
CPL	₹1,250	~₹764	About 39% lower with the same budget

The lesson

Two fixes (waste and page) moved CPL by almost 40% without a single bid change. Fix upstream layers first, then let bidding do its job.

3.12 Templates

Search terms audit log

Date	Search term	Clicks	Spend	Conv.	Decision (negative / add / watch)

Change log

Date	Campaign	Change made	Reason	Result after 2 weeks

Better data. Smarter decisions. Higher growth.

Measure honestly, cut waste, then scale what works.

About the author

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